

Orbit participant guide

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All times are Moscow time.

1. Tickets and arrival dates

Which arrival and departure dates and times are recommended?

Recommended arrival date: October 25, 2026, between 6:00 and 22:00. If no suitable flights are available on this date, participants may arrive on October 24 by prior arrangement with the organizers.

Recommended departure dates: November 1, between 21:00 and 23:59; November 2 - any time (note that hotel check-out is at 12:00).

Who purchases and pays for flight tickets?

The teams purchase and pay for the tickets themselves.

Which Moscow airports are preferred?

The nearest airports to your place of residence are Sheremetyevo (20 km), Vnukovo (40 km), Domodedovo (58 km), Zhukovsky (60 km).

Can participants arrive before the official check-in date or leave after the official check-out date?

Yes, if there are no suitable flights on the dates indicated by the organizers.

Check-in is available from October 24; check-out is available until November 2 inclusive.

Who pays for accommodation and transfers for early arrival or late departure?

For early arrival (if there are no other suitable flights) on October 24 and late departure on November 2, the organizers of the International Space Games pay for the transfer, accommodation, and meals.

If participants arrive before October 24 or leave after November 2, they cover transfers, accommodation, and meals at their own expense.

Do tickets need to be approved by the organizers before purchase?

Yes, tickets must be approved by the organizers before purchase.

When and what flight details should be submitted?

No later than October 9, 2026, submit itinerary receipts and arrival/departure flight details: date, airport, terminal, flight number, time, and number of baggage pieces.

What should you do if a flight is changed, delayed, or cancelled?

Notify the organizers immediately.

Who covers the cost of a replacement ticket or an extra hotel night due to a flight disruption?

The participant covers the cost of a replacement ticket. The possibility of covering an additional hotel night and meals should be agreed with the organizers. Keep all documents and receipts for any expenses incurred due to the disruption.

2. Airport pick-up and transfer

Who will meet the delegation, and where can you find them?

After passing border and customs control and collecting baggage, proceed to the public arrivals area. There, a volunteer will meet the team holding a sign with the country's name and the word "Orbit" (Orbita). The volunteer will escort the delegation to the transfer vehicle.

From which airports and on which days are transfers provided?

Transfers from all Moscow airports are available for October 24 and 25, and to airports on November 1 and 2. Transfer times are determined based on the delegation's flight details. Early check-in is agreed in advance.

What should you do if the volunteer is not there or the delegation is delayed?

Contact the volunteer by phone or via the chat. Provide the airport, the terminal and your current location.

Can the team travel to the hotel independently, and are these expenses reimbursed?

Yes, provided the organizers are informed in advance. Expenses for independent travel are not reimbursed.

What should you do if your luggage is lost or damaged?

Immediately inform the team's volunteer about the loss or damage.

Before leaving the baggage claim area, contact the Lost & Found service or an airline representative.

Prepare your boarding pass and baggage tag. Request a Property Irregularity Report (PIR) and obtain a copy or reference number. If your luggage is damaged, take photos.

Ask the carrier how to track and receive your luggage and how to file a claim. Keep all documents and receipts for any incurred expenses; if you have relevant insurance coverage, contact your insurer.

3. Accommodation

Hotel name, address, and contact details.

Hotel: Art Moscow

Address: 6A Kosmonavta Volkova Street, Moscow, an 11-minute walk from the nearest metro station “Voykovskaya”.

www.artmoscowhotel.ru

Phone: +7 (495) 357-77-57 (reception)

Check-in and check-out dates and times.

Standard check-in time is 15:00; check-out time is 12:00. Early check-in and late check-out depend on room availability and must be arranged in advance.

Documents required at check-in.

Identity document. Usually an international passport. Exceptions apply: citizens of EAEU countries (Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Belarus) may present their national passport if they entered Russia using it.

Migration card. This is a form with personal data and information about the purpose of the visit, which is filled out upon entry. If you arrive by plane, the form will be issued at the airport. If you enter by land (by train or car), you need to fill it out yourself. At entry, border guards take one part of the form; you submit the remaining part at the airport when leaving.

Visa. Required only if citizens of the guest’s country need a visa to enter Russia.

Participants under the age of 16 must have parental consent with them.

The consent must be brought in printed form.

Consent forms in Russian and English are available for download via the provided link.

What the hotel will do: the receptionist will make copies of your documents and fill out a notice of arrival of a foreign citizen. The hotel is obliged to submit this form to the Ministry of Internal Affairs, typically within one business day after check-in.

Who pays for accommodation, and which dates are covered by the organizers?

The basic period of stay at the expense of the organizers is from October 25 to November 2, 2026. Check-in on October 24 must be agreed separately in accordance with section 1.

How are rooms allocated, and are boys and girls accommodated separately?

Double and triple rooms are provided, with separate accommodation for boys and girls.

Is breakfast included?

All participants and delegation representatives are provided with three meals a day: breakfast, lunch, and dinner.

Does the hotel offer Wi-Fi, hairdryers, and luggage storage?

The rooms have free Wi-Fi, a hairdryer, a TV, a shower, towels, and air conditioning.

The hotel offers free Wi-Fi, a luggage storage room, and a cloakroom for early arrivals.

Is a deposit required, and who pays for it?

No hotel deposit is required.

Who should you contact if you have problems with your room or check-in?

For check-in problems, contact the volunteer. For problems with room facilities, notify the hotel administrator; if translation help is needed or the issue remains unresolved, involve the moderator. In case of immediate danger, leave the hazardous area and inform hotel staff; call 112 if necessary.

Can outside visitors be invited to the hotel?

Outside visitors are not permitted at the hotel. Only guests officially registered at check-in may stay on the hotel premises and in the rooms. This rule is in place to ensure safety and comply with the hotel’s internal regulations.

4. Getting around Moscow

How are daily transfers between the hotel and the venue organized?

A centralized transfer is provided in the morning from the hotel to the competition venue, and in the evening - to the hotel. The exact departure time and location will be communicated by the volunteer. Trips as part of the cultural program are also provided by the organizers.

What should you do if you miss the transfer?

Inform the volunteer. If a participant travels to the venue independently, they cover the cost themselves. Taxi expenses are not reimbursed.

How do participants travel during the cultural program?

All excursions scheduled as part of the cultural program are centrally organized - a transfer will be arranged for the participants.

Can participants leave the hotel or venue independently?

Underage participants are not allowed to leave the venue or hotel on their own outside competition hours; they must be accompanied by a delegation member or a volunteer.

Which taxi and public transport apps are recommended for delegation members?

Install the necessary apps before departure, check that they work, and download the Moscow map in advance for offline use.

Yandex Go - for ordering a taxi. In the app, you can specify the destination address, select a fare, and see the pick-up time. Before ordering, check the available payment method: cash or a Russian bank card.

Yandex Maps is used to find addresses and plan routes on foot, by car, and by public transport.

Yandex Metro is used for planning metro trips and finding transfer connections.

2GIS is an alternative service for searching for businesses, public transport stops, and routes. Download the map of Moscow in advance to use the available offline features.

It is enough to install the taxi app and one mapping service for the trip. Yandex Metro can be added for easier city navigation; Yandex Navigator is an option if you plan to drive a car yourself.

If you are used to Google Maps, Apple Maps or MAPS.ME, you may keep them as supplementary tools. Availability of certain features and data completeness may vary. Check key routes in advance and save the addresses of the hotel and event venue.

How do you pay for public transport?

You can use the Troika card for public transit rides. It can be purchased and topped up at metro ticket offices and vending machines. Check the price of the selected ticket type and its terms before buying.

How long does the journey to the venue and central Moscow take?

From the competition venue to central Moscow, it takes about 1 hour by public transport, or around 40 minutes by taxi. During peak hours (morning and evening), traffic jams may occur when leaving Skolkovo and on major highways. At such times, travel time can increase by 30-40 minutes or even more.

5. Money and expenses

Which expenses do the organizers cover?

Accommodation and meals on the agreed dates, transfers provided under the program, the cultural program, and insurance.

Which expenses must participants cover themselves?

• Travel to and from Moscow, including carrier fees and additional baggage.

• Visa expenses and preparation of documents, unless other conditions are agreed for the delegation.

• Communication, personal purchases and meals outside the program.

• Additional hotel services.

• Accommodation, meals and transfers outside the agreed dates.

Do you need Russian cash, and where is it safe to exchange currency?

In Russia, payments are made in Russian rubles. Visa and Mastercard cards issued by foreign banks do not work in Russian stores and ATMs. Do not expect to pay with these cards via Apple Pay or Google Pay - prepare cash in advance for personal expenses.

You can exchange foreign currency for rubles at banks and official exchange offices, including at the arrival airport. Before exchanging, check whether they accept your currency, review the exchange rate and any possible commission. It’s convenient to exchange a small amount at the airport for initial expenses, and then exchange the remainder after comparing rates in the city. Bring your passport with you.

Please observe the customs regulations when transporting cash. Upon entry, cash in all currencies and traveler’s checks up to the equivalent of USD 10,000 do not require declaration. Amounts above that must be declared. There are certain restrictions on departure: a declaration does not mean that any amount may be exported. Check the rules for your route before traveling.

How much should participants budget for personal expenses?

If you mainly stay at the event venue and hotel, move around the city minimally, and do not plan to visit many cafes and restaurants or buy souvenirs, you can manage with about 10,000 rubles.

If you plan to explore Moscow extensively, take part in extra activities, buy many souvenirs, and use taxis frequently, budget for 20,000 rubles or slightly more.

Are there ATMs or currency exchange points near the hotel and venue?

There are no currency exchange points near the competition venue.

Near the hotel, there are currency exchange options within walking distance:

Transstroybank (Leningradskoe Shosse, 8, building 2) - 850 meters from the hotel.

Hours: daily from 9:15 to 20:45, breaks: 12:00-12:15, 15:00-15:30, 18:00-18:15

Currencies: USD, EUR, CNY.

Transstroybank (Leningradskoe Shosse, 15) - 1.5 km from the hotel.

Hours: daily from 9:15 to 20:45, breaks: 12:00-12:15, 15:00-15:30, 18:00-18:15

Currencies: USD, EUR, CNY.

Are daily allowances provided to participants?

No, daily allowances for competition participants are not provided.

6. Communication and Internet

Which messengers will be the main communication channels with the organizers?

WhatsApp Messenger, Telegram.

Do participants need to join the general chat and the team’s dedicated chat in advance?

Yes, it is necessary to join the general competition participants' chat and the chat with the team volunteer assigned to the team for the duration of the competition. Links to all chat rooms and information channels will be provided.

Will Wi-Fi be available in the hotel, buses and at the venue?

Wi-Fi will be available at the hotel and at the competition venue.

Mobile communication and Internet

For a short trip, consider three options: international roaming on your existing number, a tourist eSIM, or a Russian SIM card. Prepare your chosen communication method before departure.

International roaming. Check with your mobile operator whether roaming is available in Russia, how much calls and mobile internet cost, and whether you need to activate a service package in advance.

Tourist eSIM. Before purchasing, make sure your phone supports eSIM and that the selected plan is valid in Russia. Check the data allowance, validity period, and whether the plan includes calls and SMS - some plans provide internet only. Install the eSIM according to the provider's instructions and check when the package's validity period begins.

Russian SIM card. Registration for foreign citizens requires additional documents and procedures. If you plan to purchase a local SIM card, check the current requirements with the selected operator in advance.

Do not expect guaranteed access to mobile internet immediately after arrival: there may be connection restrictions and delays. Save the hotel address, the meeting point, the moderator's and organizers' contact details, and a map of Moscow for offline use.

Which services can work with restrictions?

WhatsApp, Telegram, Instagram, Viber, Facebook, X (Twitter), YouTube, TikTok, FaceTime, Discord, LinkedIn and other services may work with restrictions. A VPN may be required for access. Some tourist eSIMs use international routing and may allow access to certain services without a VPN - check this with the provider before purchasing.

Which apps should you install before arriving in Russia?

Install WhatsApp, Telegram, Yandex Taxi, Yandex Maps, Yandex Navigator, 2GIS, Google Maps, and MAPS.ME, and download the Moscow map right away. You may also need Google Translate and Yandex Translate.

How can you contact the organizers if a messaging app is not working?

Call or send an SMS to the team volunteer or the organizers. Contact numbers will be provided before your arrival in Moscow. Save them in your phone in advance.

Organizers' 24/7 hotline number.

Contact numbers will be provided before your arrival in Moscow. Save them in your phone in advance.

7. Weather and clothing

Expected daytime and nighttime temperatures.

In Moscow, during October-November, temperatures can range from +6 °C to -6 °C during the day, and from +4 °C to -10 °C at night. Rain and sleet, as well as strong winds, are likely.

Do participants need to bring warm clothing?

Yes, you should bring a warm, waterproof jacket, closed-toe warm footwear, a hat, and gloves.

Is business attire required for opening/closing ceremonies and official meetings?

National committee representatives are advised to bring business attire for participation in formal ceremonies and official meetings.

Is sportswear or a change of clothes needed?

Yes, we recommend bringing comfortable sportswear, as well as a change of clothes and footwear for daily activities and program events.

Will there be national uniforms or clothing with the country’s symbolism?

Upon check-in at the hotel, each participant will receive branded merchandise. The set includes basic items featuring the tournament’s symbolism - these will be useful both during the events and as a keepsake souvenir.

8. Medicines and medical care

Which medicines can be brought into Russia?

Medicines for personal use that do not contain controlled substances can generally be imported without a special permit. We recommend keeping the original packaging and, for prescription medications, bringing a prescription or a doctor's statement.

Special rules apply to medicines containing narcotic, psychotropic, potent, or poisonous substances. Check in advance whether a specific medication is allowed to be imported, the requirements for medical documents, their translation, and customs declaration. A prescription may not be sufficient.

Check the active ingredients, not just the brand name: a medication being freely sold in your country does not mean it can be freely imported into Russia. For medications containing narcotic or psychotropic substances, a prescription in the participant's name with a notarized Russian translation is required.

Where can participants store medicines that require special conditions?

If a participant needs to store medicines that require specific conditions (e.g., a certain temperature range, protection from light, or other special requirements), it is important to inform the organizers in advance. The organizers will do their best to resolve this issue.

Please notify the moderator and indicate the following in the designated field during registration:

which medicine needs to be stored;

what conditions are required for it (for example, temperature from +2 to +8 °C, storage in a dark place, etc.);

the quantity of the medicine and how long it needs to be stored.

Where can medical assistance be obtained at the venue?

A medical professional will be on duty at the venue throughout the competition days. If you feel unwell or sustain an injury, immediately inform your team’s moderator - they will escort you to the medical staff.

Which hospital should be contacted if needed?

All members of the Orbit teams are covered by medical insurance. If you need medical assistance outside the venue, inform your team volunteer. They will help you contact the insurance company and clarify which clinic to visit under your insurance coverage.

In case of a life-threatening emergency, call 112 immediately without waiting for the moderator’s response. After making the call, inform the moderator about what happened.

What to do if an infectious disease is suspected?

Inform the team's volunteer immediately. They will help contact the insurance company and arrange a medical visit. Until you receive medical recommendations, limit contact with other participants. The possibility of continued participation in the program will be determined based on the doctor's recommendations.

Who accompanies the participant to the hospital?

As a rule, the participant is accompanied by the team volunteer. If they are unavailable, the organizers will assign another volunteer who speaks English or their own representative. The accompanying person will help with organizational matters and communication with medical staff.

Who notifies the head of the delegation, the university, relatives, and the embassy?

The volunteer first informs the head of the delegation. The embassy or consulate is involved if consular assistance is needed, including matters related to documents or stay in Russia. In complex cases, coordination between all parties is handled by the ISG organizers.

9. Equipment and customs

Do participants need to bring their own equipment?

No. The organizers provide the equipment needed to complete the tasks.

Is it possible to bring personal laptops, phones and cameras?

Yes, participants are encouraged to bring personal laptops, phones, cameras, and other devices - they can be used both during the competition and outside of it.

Are there restrictions on the transportation of personal electronics and batteries?

Check your airline’s requirements for transporting laptops, batteries, and power banks before your trip. Rules vary depending on the device type, battery capacity, and the carrier’s policies. If your journey involves multiple airlines, review the requirements for each one.

What types of power outlets are used, and are adapters needed?

In Russia, power outlets of types C and F (with round pins) are used. If your devices have a different plug type, bring a suitable adapter.

10. Emergency situations

The unified emergency number of Russia is 112

Calls are free from any mobile or landline phone. The number works even if the phone has no SIM card, the SIM is blocked, or the account balance is zero.

When you call, the operator will connect you to the necessary service - the fire service, police, or ambulance service.

24/7 headquarters number for Orbit.

Contact numbers will be provided before your arrival in Moscow. Save them in your phone in advance.

Volunteer for a specific delegation.

Contact numbers will be provided before your arrival in Moscow. Save them in your phone in advance.

Hotel contact details.

Hotel: Art Moscow

Address: Moscow, Kosmonavta Volkova St., 6A; 11-minute walk from the Voykovskaya metro station.

Website: www.artmoscowhotel.ru

Phone: +7 (495) 357-77-57 (reception)

Competition venue address.

Skolca Innovative Private School

Address: Moscow, Skolkovo Innovation Center, Bolshoy b-r, 37

Embassy or consulate contact details.

Kazakhstan

Address: Chistoprudny Bulvar, 3, bld. 2

Phone numbers: +7 (495) 627-18-12 (general), +7 (495) 627-17-06 (consular department), +7 (925) 897-71-14 (consular hotline: weekdays 9:00-18:00, lunch break 13:00-14:00; for emergencies - 24/7).

Website: www.gov.kz/memleket/entities/mfa-moscow

Opening hours: Mon, Tue, Thu, Fri 09:00-18:00 (break 13:00-14:00).

Uzbekistan

Address: Pogorelsky pereulok, 12 (Embassy); 2nd Kazachiy pereulok, 2 (consular department).

Phone numbers: +7 (499) 230-00-78 (reception), +7 (499) 230-00-76, +7 (499) 238-36-20, +7 (499) 230-00-32 (consular department).

Website: www.uzembassy.ru

Opening hours: Mon-Fri 09:00-17:00 (break 13:00-14:00).

UAE

Address: Olof Palme Street, 4.

Phone numbers: +7 (495) 234-40-60 (consular department).

Website: https://www.mofaic.gov.ae/en/Missions/Moscow

Opening hours: Mon-Fri 09:00-16:00 (consular department for documents and applications: Mon-Fri 09:00-17:00).

South Africa

Address: Granatny pereulok, 1, bldg. 9.

Phone numbers: +7 (495) 926-11-77.

Website: http://www.saembassy.ru/ru/

Opening hours: Mon-Fri 08:30-17:00 (Embassy); Mon-Fri 10:30-15:00, Friday until 14:00 (consular department).

India

Address: Vorontsovo Pole, 6-8, building 1

Phones: +7 (495) 783-75-35 (general), +7 (495) 916-23-43 (consular department)

Website: www.indianembassy-moscow.gov.in

Opening hours: Mon-Fri 09:30-17:30 (break 13:30-14:00).

Belarus

Address: Maroseika, 17/6.

Phone numbers: +7 (495) 777-66-44 (general), +7 (495) 624-70-95 (consular department).

Website: https://www.russia.mfa.gov.by/ru/

Opening hours: Fri 9:00-13:00 and 14:00-18:00 (Sat, Sun - closed).

What should you do if you lose your passport?

Inform the team's volunteer immediately. They will help with translation, arranging the necessary inquiries, and coordinating with the organizers.

Contact the police and file a report about the loss or theft of your passport. Obtain a document confirming that you've reported the incident.

Contact the consulate of your country. Ask about the procedure for obtaining a new passport or a temporary document for returning home. Prepare a copy of your lost passport and other identity documents, if any.

Together with the volunteer and the organizers, clarify whether you need to restore your visa, migration card, or update your migration registration information. If the flight is scheduled in the near future, inform the consulate and the organizers.

The exact list of documents and the time needed to obtain them depend on the requirements of the consulate of your country.

What should you do if you lose your phone, money, or luggage?

Inform the team's volunteer immediately. They will help with translation and further inquiries.

If your phone is lost:

Call your number from another device and check the places where you might have left your phone.

Use the device search service to determine its location and enable lost mode or remote lock.

Contact the operator to block the SIM card. If there is a risk of access to banking applications, inform the bank.

If you suspect theft, contact the police. If possible, prepare the device's IMEI number.

If money or bank cards are lost:

If you lose your card, immediately block it through the bank's app or hotline.

Check places where you might have left your belongings and contact the staff at the hotel, venue, or transport service.

If you suspect theft, file a police report.

Communication

Use polite forms of address. When communicating with teachers, experts, and official representatives, use the name and form of address the person introduced themselves with. In Russian conversations with people you don't know well, it's customary to use the formal "вы" (you) form.

Avoid overly familiar language. Terms like "brother," "sister," and similar expressions are best used only when you're sure the other person is comfortable with them.

Respect personal boundaries. Don't insist on discussing politics, religion, income, or personal life if the other person doesn't seem willing to talk about these topics.

Show gratitude for help. Simple words like "thank you," "please," and "sorry" help keep the conversation friendly and respectful.

Help everyone take part in the discussion. When talking about general matters, choose language that everyone understands, or briefly translate what was said. In private conversations, you're free to use whatever language is comfortable for you.

In public places

Avoid disturbing others with noise. Observe the quiet hours established at the hotel, especially in the evenings and at night.

Be considerate of other passengers. On public transport, keep your voice down, use headphones, and avoid using the speakerphone. If possible, give up your seat for elderly people, pregnant women, and passengers with small children.

Keep public areas clean. Throw trash in bins and tidy up after yourself in common areas.

Respect photography restrictions. Pay attention to prohibition signs and the venue’s visiting rules. If you’re unsure whether photography is allowed, ask a staff member or moderator. Always ask people for their consent before taking their photo.

Don’t block walkways. On sidewalks and in transport, leave space for other people; don’t linger near doors. Use sidewalks and cross the street only at designated crossings.

Personal boundaries and cultural considerations

Respect religious and cultural differences. If you need a space for prayer or any other special arrangements, inform the organizers in advance so you can discuss possible solutions.

Be mindful of attitudes toward physical contact. Avoid hugging or touching people you don’t know well without their consent. When interacting with children who aren’t your own, consider the position of their parents or accompanying adults.

Use simple, polite words. Russian phrases like “здравствуйте” (hello), “спасибо” (thank you), “пожалуйста” (please), and “извините” (sorry/excuse me) will help in everyday communication.

Rules for minors at the venue

At the competition venue, minors are prohibited from:

smoking tobacco or using electronic cigarettes;

consuming any alcoholic beverages, narcotic or toxic substances, or stimulants;

using offensive language or insulting other participants, spectators, or organizers;

bringing or carrying any type of weapon, sharp or pointed objects, explosive devices, explosives, toxic, flammable, or other hazardous substances onto the premises;

bringing fire hazards or pyrotechnic items (flares, firecrackers, gas canisters), as well as objects that could be used as weapons;

bringing soft drinks in glass, metal, or plastic containers with a volume exceeding 0.5 litres;

throwing objects in the direction of other people;

creating a threat to their own safety, life, and health, as well as to the safety, life, and health of others (e.g., climbing on railings, parapets, or load-bearing structures);

writing or drawing on structures and facilities without the organizers' permission;

entering technical areas, VIP zones, or any other areas where access is restricted by the organizers;

holding public events not provided for in the competition regulations;

using sound-amplification equipment (radios, powerful speakers), laser devices, or flashlights unless approved by the organizers;

consuming food and drinks that do not meet sanitary and epidemiological requirements (including items purchased outside the designated areas on the competition venue, if explicitly prohibited by the regulations).

Rules for minors at the hotel

At the hotel, minors are prohibited from:

smoking;

consuming alcoholic beverages;

using offensive language when communicating with staff or other participants;

disturbing other guests (playing loud music, making noise late at night);

leaving trash in the room or common areas, or damaging property;

using electrical devices improperly (e.g., leaving them on unattended);

opening windows or doors in a way that may create a safety hazard (fire, falling);

bringing or carrying prohibited items into the hotel (weapons, explosives, flammable liquids, etc.);

handing their pass or room key to other people;

consuming food and drinks that do not meet sanitary and epidemiological requirements.

Minor participants are also advised not to leave the hotel after 23:00. In exceptional cases (a valid reason or emergency), leaving is only permitted when accompanied by a team volunteer or a team chaperone.